

WILDERNESS FIRST AID

Quick Reference Card

Provider Card — Carry at all times

PRIMARY SURVEY — XABCDE

- X — eXsanguination: Stop life-threatening hemorrhage FIRST
- A — Airway: Open? Clear? Maintain?
- B — Breathing: Rate, effort, effectiveness
- C — Circulation: Pulse quality, skin signs
- D — Disability: AVPU, pupils, neuro
- E — Expose/Environment: Find injuries, prevent hypothermia

AVPU

A = Alert (×4) | V = Verbal | P = Pain | U = Unresponsive

Note: V, P, U = evacuate

SAMPLE History

- S-Signs/Symptoms A-Allergies M-Medications P-Pertinent Hx
- L-Last oral intake E-Events leading up

OPQRST (Pain Assessment)

- O-Onset P-Provocation Q-Quality R-Radiation S-Severity T-Time

DCAP-BTLS (Head-to-Toe)

- D-Deformity C-Contusions A-Abrasions P-Punctures
- B-Burns T-Tenderness L-Lacerations S-Swelling

VITALS — Normal Adult Ranges

- Pulse: 60–100 bpm | Resp: 12–20/min
- Cap refill: <2 sec | Temp: 98.6°F (37°C)
- Reassess: q15min (unstable) / q30min (stable)

TREATMENT REFERENCE

Treatment protocols & evacuation criteria

BLEEDING CONTROL

1. Don PPE
 2. Direct pressure 10+ min
 3. Tourniquet if uncontrolled
- TQ: 2–3" proximal, tighten till stop,
mark TIME, do NOT remove

SHOCK TREATMENT

Supine, legs 6–12" up (no spinal Hx)
Warm. Oral fluids if alert. Control hemorrhage.
EVACUATE.

SPLINTING

CSM before + after. Immobilize joint above/below.
Pad prominences. Firm, not tight. Reassess q30min.

ANAPHYLAXIS

Epi FIRST (outer thigh, through clothing, 10s)
Position: supine (shock) or sitting (difficulty breathing)
Antihistamines secondary. EVACUATE IMMEDIATELY.

HEAT STROKE

Altered LOC + hot skin = EMERGENCY
Cool FIRST: cold immersion > ice axilla/neck/groin
Do NOT give oral fluids if altered LOC.

HYPOTHERMIA

Remove wet. Insulate from ground. Vapor barrier.
Heat packs: armpits/groin (NOT bare skin).
Handle GENTLY. "Not dead until warm & dead"

URGENT EVACUATION (1–2 hrs)

- | | |
|------------------------------|---------------------------|
| ■ Altered/declining LOC | ■ Uncontrolled hemorrhage |
| ■ Suspected spinal injury | ■ Heat stroke |
| ■ Severe hypothermia | ■ Anaphylaxis |
| ■ Chest pain / resp distress | ■ Open fracture |
| ■ Femur fracture | ■ Stroke (FAST+) |